



Above Camembert and chives provide a savory *crêpe* filling, ideally washed down with some chilled Breton cider

Left Quimper's recently restored granite cathedral, with its distinctive twin spires, towers over the city's half-timbered houses



Above Women wearing traditional headdresses, the strikingly shaped *coiffe bigoudène*, as part of a Breton religious procession

Crêpe Festivals

Fête de la Crêpe On the last weekend in July, the *crêpe* takes pride of place in the village of Gourin, in Morbihan. Breton dancing, pipe bands, Celtic singers, exhibitions by local artists, and, of course, fresh *crêpes* provide entertainment for all.

Rennes festival In May and June, *crêperies* in the city of Rennes compete to win the title of best *galette* and best *crêpe*. Pancake eaters are spoiled for choice, with everyone vying for accolades.

Fête de la Galette On the last Sunday in September, Pipriac, in Ille-et-Vilaine, hosts its *galette* festival. Expect a *galette*-making competition, buckwheat exhibitions, and Celtic concerts.

The Best Places to Eat Crêpes

Crêperie An Diskuiz inexpensive

Billing itself as a *crêperie gourmande*, this establishment is serious about what it puts on a plate — only 100 percent quality buckwheat and wheat *crêpes*. Settle into the tiny stone-walled room with its wooden beams and tables splashed with red, yellow, and pale green cloths, order a house cocktail (kir with chestnut cream in winter, or morello cherries and sparkling apple juice in summer) and study the menu. Savory *crêpe* offerings include *Cabri*, filled with goat cheese, bacon, walnuts, and cream; *La Dahouet*, stuffed with scallops from Saint Brieuc and leek fondue; and *Côte d'Emeraude* — a creamy melange of scallops, mushrooms, bacon, and parsley. Dessert *crêpes* feature local products such as jellies from Vergers du Cap Coz and de Fouesnant honey, with combinations including orange marmalade with chocolate enveloped in a black wheat *crêpe*, and one bursting with seasonal fruit. Wash it down with farmhouse cider or, better still, apple brandy.

12 rue Elie Fréron, Quimper; open noon–2 PM Mon–Sat, 7–10 PM Mon–Tue, Thu–Sat; +33 2 9895 5570

Also in Quimper

Sainte Catherine (+33 2 9853 2824; *inexpensive*), in the shadow of Quimper's cathedral, dishes up *crêpes* bursting with local goodness. Seafood fanciers will fall for the buckwheat pancake with mussels, scallops, shrimp, and mushrooms in a saffron sauce, while meat-eaters can opt for hearty black pudding and pan-fried apples. Sweet treats include an oozy salted caramel *crêpe*.

Also in France

Crêperies are a common sight in Paris, but they're rarely the real Breton deal. For that, you need to head to the rue du Montparnasse in the 14th arrondissement. The reason?

Montparnasse station, the hub for trains to and from Brittany, is close by. Two popular *crêpe* crusaders in the street are **Crêperie de Josselin** (+33 1 4320 9350; *inexpensive*) at number 67 and **Crêperie Saint-Malo** (+33 1 4320 8719; *inexpensive*) at number 53. The flambéed apple and maple syrup *crêpe* here will crank up lagging sugar levels.

Around the World

French expat Sylvie Lemer is responsible for bringing some Breton flavor to San Francisco's funky Mission district. At **Ti Couz** (415-252-7373; *moderate*), she cooks up thin buckwheat *galettes* embracing fat scallops in a buttery sauce or classic ham and cheese, and sweet *crêpes* like the decadent white chocolate and Chantilly cream.